PRIME HEALTH

June 16, 2025

Assistant Secretary for Technology Policy
Office of the National Coordinator for Health Information Technology
Department of Health and Human Services
Mary E. Switzer Building, 7033A
330 C Street SW
Washington, DC 20201
Attention: Centers for Medicare & Medicaid Services [CMS–0042–NC] RIN 0938–AV68 Request for Information; Health Information; Health Technology Ecosystem

Dear Assistant Secretary for Technology Policy (ASTP)/ Office of the National Coordinator for Health Information Technology (ONC), and Department of Health and Human Services (HHS):

As an integral part of Colorado's healthcare and innovation ecosystem, Prime Health appreciates the opportunity to submit comments on the Office of the Assistant Secretary for Technology Policy and Office of the National Coordinator for Health Information Technology (ASTP/ONC) and Department of Health and Human Services (HHS), Request for Information (RFI), Heath Technology Ecosystem, CMS–0042–NC. We are submitting our comments in collaboration with two of our partner organizations in the Colorado health technology and health care access space, Community Managed Care Network/Community Health Provider Alliance (CCMCN/CHPA), a unified care network focused on improving patient outcomes, and Colorado Access, the state's largest public sector health plan. We each focus our comments on the health programs and systems questions posed by the RFI that fall in our intersecting or particular expertise and organizational experience. As preferred, our responses are grouped by topic, headed with the applicable question numbers from the RFI. To make our response quickly digestible and easily understood, we are providing our comments in bullet format within those questions and topics.

If you have any questions or would like further information, please contact Sarah Lampe, President & CEO, Prime Health; Jason Greer, CEO, CCMCN/CHPA; or Ashlie Brown, Chief Strategy & Technology Officer, Colorado Access.

Thank you again for inviting our input,

Sarah Lampe
President & CEO, Prime Health

Prime Health

CMS Health Technology Ecosystem RFI Response

Organization: Prime Health Colorado
Website: primehealthco.com
Contact: Sarah Lampe, President & CEO, sarah@primehealthco.com

Coordination Note: This response is part of a coordinated submission with Prime Health Colorado, Colorado Access, and Colorado Community Managed Care/Community Health Provider Alliance, representing key players in Colorado's health technology ecosystem. Each partner also works closely with government agencies, foundations, and other providers across the Colorado health landscape. Colorado is a living lab with extensive experience in building collaborative ecosystems in health policy, innovation, and funding, and is non-coastal, with a mix of urban, suburban, rural and frontier areas. Fragmented regulations about sharing social health information are a common hurdle across Colorado regions and nationally. Building in open architecture requirements and receiving enough funding to enforce them; be intentional about funding an interoperable ecosystem and not merely supporting individual company opportunities to profit off of data.

Prime Health and our partners would also like to contribute to a national set of best practices and standards around building for innovation ecosystems that support Medicaid and Medicare, and help determine what unifying policies would allow us to most efficiently utilize health care data in the most cost effective way, to drive better patient outcomes and satisfaction.

Organization Overview

Prime Health Colorado is a health innovation accelerator and convener focused on advancing fair healthcare access through technology entrepreneurship. We support diverse founders building health solutions that address system-wide healthcare disparities, with particular expertise in rural health technology and culturally appropriate digital health products. We convene stakeholders from across multiple industries, organizations, backgrounds and perspectives to build community, consensus, coordination and capabilities as a means to solve problems by catalyzing innovation, implementing pilot programs, and accelerating sustainable health care reform.

Key RFI Responses

TD-1: Stimulating Developer Interest for Medicare Beneficiaries

Short-term (2 years):

- Create Medicare-focused accelerator tracks specifically addressing rural and resource-constrained populations

- Stimulate local ecosystems to support and incentivize entrepreneurship within existing ecosystems and partnerships
- Establish pilot partnerships with Colorado's safety net providers and Community Health Centers
- Develop fair access-centered digital therapeutics for chronic disease management

Long-term:

- Scale successful Colorado rural health pilots nationally
- Build comprehensive fair access measurement tools for Medicare Advantage plans
- Develop AI-powered culturally appropriate care navigation platforms
- Create interoperable social determinants data platforms
- Tie developer engagement in Medicare beneficiaries to existing quantum efforts in Colorado

PC-1: Health Management App Priorities

Based on our portfolio companies and Colorado market analysis:

- Rural telehealth platforms optimized for limited broadband infrastructure
- Social determinants integration connecting with multiple systems, like Colorado's 211 system
- Multilingual care navigation addressing Colorado's nearly 23% Hispanic/Latino population
- Transportation coordination tools for accessing specialty care across rural areas where health care resources are often a great distance away
- Cultural appropriateness AI for personalized health recommendations

TD-2: Most Valuable Additional CMS Data

Our startups consistently request:

- Social determinants data integrated with local 211 and health systems
- Transportation utilization patterns for rural care access
- Language preferences and cultural appropriateness indicators
- Fair access metrics at ZIP code level
- Behavioral health integration data with primary care

VB-1: ACO Digital Health Adoption Incentives

Current Innovation Obstacles:

- Limited technical infrastructure in rural partner providers
- Variable patient technology literacy across diverse populations
- Complex integration requirements across multiple EHR systems
- Lack of fair access-focused quality measures
- “Pilot fatigue” - provider organizations aiming to partner with innovative companies often lack staff time and resources to devote to multiple sets of KPI tracking and reporting, and

there is no unified standard for reporting on shared KPIs across agencies, programs, or funding sources, either on a broad a level as across Medicare and Medicaid, or across potential grant funders at state or local levels.

Recommended Incentives:

- Shared savings bonuses tied to fair access digital tool adoption
- Technical assistance funding prioritizing rural and safety net providers
- Quality measure credits for culturally appropriate technology implementation
- Innovation waivers for pilot programs addressing social determinants

Colorado Health Innovation Ecosystem Strengths

Our accelerator network demonstrates Colorado's unique position:

- Strong university partnerships (CU Anschutz, CSU, Colorado School of Mines, Colorado Community College System)
- Rural-urban connectivity providing real-world testing environments
- Diverse startup ecosystem, with 40% minority and women founders among Prime Health Challenge finalist and winning companies
- Commitment to fair healthcare access across all major health systems
- Collaborative culture enabling cross-sector partnerships

Our Vision of an Innovation Ecosystem Framework for Medicaid and Medicare

Best Practices for Supporting Medicaid and Medicare Innovation Ecosystems

Colorado's experience as a living laboratory for health innovation has revealed critical best practices for building sustainable ecosystems that effectively serve Medicare and Medicaid populations. Successful innovation ecosystems require three foundational elements: coordinated governance structures, shared technical infrastructure, and aligned financial incentives.

Coordinated Governance: Effective ecosystems establish clear governance frameworks that connect state agencies, federal programs, health plans, providers, and technology vendors. Colorado's collaborative model demonstrates how state Medicaid agencies can serve as ecosystem orchestrators, facilitating partnerships between Medicare Advantage plans, Federally Qualified Health Centers, and emerging technology companies. This coordination prevents duplicative efforts and ensures innovations address real population needs rather than creating solutions in search of problems.

Effective ecosystems establish clear governance frameworks that connect state agencies, federal programs, health plans, providers, and technology vendors. Colorado's collaborative

model demonstrates how an organization serving as an ecosystem orchestrator can facilitate partnerships between state agencies like Medicaid, safety-net providers like Federally Qualified Health Centers, behavioral health organizations, and even public libraries, and emerging technology companies. This coordination prevents duplicative efforts and ensures innovations address real population needs rather than creating solutions in search of problems.

Shared Technical Infrastructure: Rather than supporting individual company opportunities to profit from data silos, successful ecosystems invest in open architecture requirements that enable interoperability from the ground up. Colorado's 211 system integration exemplifies how shared infrastructure can amplify individual innovations, but that is a starting point. When startups build on common data standards and shared APIs, their solutions become more valuable to both Medicare and Medicaid programs while reducing integration costs for providers.

Aligned Financial Incentives: Innovation ecosystems thrive when funding mechanisms reward collaboration over competition. Medicare Innovation Center partnerships with regional accelerators create financial incentives for startups to address population health challenges rather than just profitable niches. Shared savings models that include innovation bonuses encourage health systems to adopt new technologies while ensuring sustainability.

Unifying Data Policies for Cost-Effective Healthcare Innovation

The most significant barrier to efficient healthcare data utilization is fragmented regulatory frameworks that create compliance burdens without improving outcomes. Three policy unification strategies can dramatically improve cost-effectiveness while maintaining necessary protections.

Standardized Social Determinants Integration: Current regulations create inconsistent requirements for sharing social health information across states and programs. A unified federal framework for social determinants data sharing would enable Medicare and Medicaid programs to leverage existing community resources like 211 systems more effectively. Rather than requiring separate data collection processes, unified standards would allow single data entry to serve multiple program requirements, reducing administrative burden while improving care coordination.

Interoperable Quality Measurement: Medicare and Medicaid programs currently require overlapping but distinct quality measures, forcing providers to maintain separate reporting systems. Unified quality measurement standards that serve both programs would reduce provider burden while enabling more comprehensive population health analysis. This approach would allow healthcare organizations to invest in single, robust data systems rather than maintaining parallel reporting infrastructure.

Coordinated Innovation Authorities: Federal agencies currently operate separate innovation authorities that can create conflicting requirements for emerging technologies. A unified innovation framework that coordinates CMS Innovation Center activities with other federal agencies or programs, like ONC Health IT certification requirements, would streamline market entry for beneficial technologies while maintaining appropriate oversight. This coordination would reduce regulatory uncertainty that currently prevents many promising innovations from reaching Medicare and Medicaid beneficiaries.

The Colorado experience demonstrates that when these unifying policies are implemented thoughtfully, they create multiplicative effects. Shared infrastructure investments become more valuable, innovation cycles accelerate, and healthcare organizations can focus resources on improving outcomes rather than managing regulatory complexity. Most importantly, unified approaches ensure that innovations developed for one population can more easily benefit others, maximizing return on public investment in healthcare innovation. This effect is amplified when a population or region with health access challenges is successfully addressed; a solution developed to positively impact those hardest to reach will serve the population as a whole more easily.

Policy Recommendations

Fair Access Technology Requirements

- Require accessibility standards addressing barriers to care
- Create fair access measurement requirements for all digital therapeutics
- Mandate multilingual interfaces for digital health products serving diverse populations
- Establish cultural appropriateness standards for AI-driven health applications

Rural Health Technology Support

- Dedicated funding streams for rural health technology infrastructure
- Simplified certification processes for rural-appropriate solutions
- Technical assistance programs for Critical Access Hospitals
- Broadband infrastructure requirements for health technology deployment

Innovation Acceleration

- Medicare Innovation Center partnerships with regional health accelerators and innovation ecosystem partners
- Fast-track approval processes for fair access-focused digital therapeutics
- Pilot program waivers for social determinants data integration
- Startup-friendly API sandbox environments for rapid prototyping
- Central hub to access resources, information and connection with partners across the state's innovation ecosystem, including state agencies, non-profits, incubators & accelerators, health tech investors, foundations, and start-up companies

Entrepreneur Education in Safety Net Populations:

- Medicaid, Medicare, CMMI and other CMS component organizations
- Social determinants navigation and education including SNAP, housing, etc.
- Billing and other funding mechanisms

Commitment to Collaboration

Prime Health Colorado commits to:

- Serving as pilot partner for innovative health technology initiatives
- Providing expertise in fair access-focused technology development
- Facilitating connections between CMS and innovative health startups
- Supporting evaluation and scaling of successful rural health technology solutions
- Expanding our offerings into an accessible resource hub & ecosystem connector

Our coordinated response with many of Colorado's major health organizations demonstrates our ecosystem's readiness to advance national health technology policy while prioritizing fair healthcare access and rural connectivity.